

Telegram – Privacy Review Report

1. What personal data Telegram collects

- Basic account data: phone number, display name, profile photo, bio, optional birthday, optional email.
- Messages: cloud chats stored encrypted on Telegram servers, secret chats end-to-end encrypted and not stored, public posts.
- Contacts: synced phonebook numbers and names.
- Metadata: IP address, device info, username history, usage patterns (stored up to 12 months).
- Location: shared or live location.
- Payments: shipping info, payment tokens (card details held by payment providers).
- Bots: messages you send to bots and public profile data.

2. App permissions required

- Contacts access
- Camera
- Microphone
- Storage/Media
- Location (optional)
- Call logs on Android (optional auto-verification)
- Notifications
- Network access

3. Is Telegram ethical in terms of privacy?

Positives:

- No targeted ads based on user data
- Strong deletion controls and account self-destruction
- Secret chats offer true end-to-end encryption
- Open-source client with reproducible builds
- Minimal required data for functionality

Concerns:

- Cloud chats are not end-to-end encrypted
- Metadata stored for up to 12 months
- Bots run by third-party developers can access your data
- Phone number required for account creation
- Google/Microsoft used for translations and transcription

4. Final Summary – Is this app ethical?

Telegram provides a better-than-average approach to privacy compared to most major messaging apps. It avoids data-driven advertising and gives users meaningful control over message deletion and encryption. However, it isn't fully private because cloud chats aren't end-to-end encrypted and bots can access user data.

Overall: Telegram is reasonably ethical for privacy-conscious users, but maximum privacy requires using secret chats and avoiding bots.